UXID 111 | 10/02/25 | KEIRA VAUGHAN | KAV77

Sisters of Mercy

Hermanas de la Misericordia

Elevator Pitch

“The Sisters of Mercy have been helping those in need around the world for 200 years. However with technology growing they have struggled to keep up with younger audiences. I believe by updating their website, creating more engaging social media content, and researching younger audiences they can grow their volunteer base. Consider looking into their social media, volunteer events, or donating to help strengthen their cause.”

Purpose

The purpose of this research report is to present findings from my study and discuss future changes for the **Sisters of Mercy** future UX strategy.

Sisters of Mercy
Hermanas de la Misericordia

Agenda

Purpose

Executive Summary

Backgrounds & Overview

Methodology

Key Findings

Opportunities & Recommendations

TOPIC ANOTHER TOPIC

Background & Overview

About The Sisters of Mercy,

Background

The Sisters of Mercy were founded in 1847 by an Irish woman named Catherine McAuley, who opened a shelter for women. Now they are a religious based organization that provide social services, rehabilitation and support.
They connect with schools to make Mercy schools, centered in the Sisters of Mercy's values.
Their 5 main critical concerns are

- Earth
- Immigration
- Nonviolence
- Racism
- Women

Key Partners

- Mercy based organizations
- Institutional Partnerships
- Social Justice Partnerships
- Faith Driven Supporters

Activities

Marketing
Community Advocacy and Outreach
Program Development
Running Campaigns

Value propositions

Advocacy/ Charity
Founded by women
Faith based Organization

Cost Structures

Service Collaboration
Educational Institutions
Human Resources
Property Maitenence

Key Resources

Human Resources
Financial Assets
Intellectual Property
Physical Assets

Revenue Streams

Investment income
Donations and Legacies
Fundraising Events
Service Fees

Customer Segments

Legacy & Donors
Service Users
Volunteers & Activists

Channels

Media/ Press
Partnerships/ Collaborations
Events
Email Newsletters

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Begining Changes

1. **Adding Personalization to the Website**: Creating a section where you can create an account. They can list topics they are passionate on to create an algorithm for events and articles
2. **Creating a meaningful experience for Donors:** S Sending notifications of impact updates on the cause they donated to will keep the users engaged post donation.
3. **Increasing Youth engagement**: Creating a strong brand identity, and adding new processes on social media will attract younger users.Like creating video articles on social media.

TOPIC TESTING

Methodology

How I conducted the testing

Stakeholder Interview
KPI's/7Ps
User Interviews
User Personas
Empathy Mapping
Survey

Stakeholder Interview

Summary:

- Younger and Older audiences respond to real stories.
- People don’t know where to start on the website.
- Trying to engage with younger audiences
- There are dIfferent needs for different ages.
- Want to create a cohesive experience that is clear to understand.

KPI's

- **Volunteer Retention Rate –** % of returning Volunteers.
- **Pages per Session-** Number of pages visited per session to show depth of engagement.
- **Volunteer Sign-Ups-** The number of new volunteers joining new programs or signing up for events.
- **Engagement Rate-** Number of likes, comments, shares in comparison to followers.

7P's

Product	Process	Physical Evidence	Price	Place	Promotion	People
Housing, Meals, Counseling, Eduaction Programs, 200 organizations	Non-profit, Donations, Volunteers, Mercy schools fund as well	Mercy Centers, Hospitals, Schools, Retreat Facilities, locations around the world	Social media, newsletters, emails, events	Staff: Sisters, Social Workers, educators Volunteers: students of mercy schools, alumni, Donors	Learn through social media, "Our work" tab, look into values	Stories online, Mercy archives (past stories), digital presence for sign-ups and donations

SWOT Analysis

Strengths: Clear mission, trusted reputation, Integrated Educational Outreach

Weaknesses: Outdated Design, Lack of Visual Hierarchy, Inconsistent Posting,

Opportunities: Public awareness, Advocacy influencers on social media, donation journeys

Threats: Changing User Behaviors, other non profit organizations

User Interviews Summary

Grace

- Grace feels disconnected with The Sisters of Mercy after she graduated
- Her preferred source of content is social media like instagram
- She wishes there was more volunteer work after graduation
- Preffers text updates instead of emails

Kristine

- Wants more involvement with Mercy School families
- Think there could be some adjustments made to the website
- Prefers emails and texts
- Likes to read story articles
- Donates every so often

User Journey mapping

User Goals

- *Easier Volunteer sign up process*
- *Be able to do one time volunteering*
- *More engaged donating process*

User Needs

- *Easy donation process*
- *Close volunteering*
- *Know where to find information on website*
- *One-time Volunteering*
- *Clear to read for font size and style*
- *Trouble with newer technology*

Experience:

- Struggled to find where to volunteer because of unclear taps
- Clicked through many tabs until getting to the right section
- Felt frustrated by the time she found the tab
- Once she found the tabs about volunteering she was happier

Interviews and Surveys

Interview Questions

1. To start, can you tell me a little bit about how you first heard about The Sisters of Mercy or their work in your area?
2. How often did you volunteer in High school.
3. How do you stay connected with The Sisters of Mercy?
4. If you were to need a service from The Sisters of Mercy, how easy/ difficult would it be to find one?
5. What kind of services made you feel the most fulfilled?
6. Do you donate to the Sisters of Mercy?
7. How do you prefer to get updates or information from The Sisters of Mercy?
8. Have you ever contacted The Sisters of Mercy with a question or concern? If so, how was that experience?
9. What's one thing The Sisters of Mercy could do that would make your experience better or easier?
10. Is there anything else you'd like to share about your experience—positive or negative—

Demographics:

1. How old are you?
2. What sections of the Website are most important to you?
3. If you have any **Accessibility needs**, are those needs met? If so what are the tools that help you?
4. How often do you access the Sisters of Mercy's website?
5. How easy is it to find specific things you are looking for on the website?
6. How visually **appealing** do you find the website?
7. Do you engage with posts, or follow The Sisters of Mercy on social media
8. How do you feel about their social media presence?
9. What kind of content do you feel are the most engaging on their social media?
10. Are there any problems you run into on the Website or Social Media?

- Yes(please describe below)
- No

1. If yes, please explain what is hard to use.
2. If you could change one thing about the website what would it be?

Would you be willing to participate in a brief follow-up interview (by video) to help us better understand your experience? If yes, please leave your contact info below. We will only use it to reach out for scheduling.

SURVEYS

INTERVIEWS

Key Findings

Answers from Surveys

Findings

- Interviews
- Survey
- Empathy Mapping
- User Journey

User Survey/Interview:

Users feel disconnected,
prefered source of content is social media,
wishes there was more connection after graduation from mercy schools,
prefers texts over emails.

Empathy Mapping

- Lack of engagement on social media
- Doesn’t enjoy the email newsletters
- Wishes there were more volunteering events

User Journey Map

- Section names are unclear
- Some sections are not updated
- Donating is at the bottom of the donation page, easily missed
- Volunteer page takes you to a different website

FEATURES

Opportunities & Recommendations

Based on our recomendations

Opportunities

- Make name changes to tabs to make them more clear
- Post more on social media
  - like video stories about volunteering
  - Post more about events
  - Alumni events on social media
  - campaigns
- Donation Journey
  - Send information about what the donor helped to do
  - Personalize the donation journey
- Personalization to Website
  - Log-in page to set up an algorithim for articles of interest.

Reccomendations

- Expand to texts about current events instead of just email newsletters
  - Connects both younger and older audiences
- Make volunteer signup on same website for easier process
- Make important information pop more on website so things are easier to find

Thank you!